

Career Goals, Self-Reflection

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Career Planning and Portfolio Development

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Introduction

I have a bachelor degree in Computer Science & Engineering and 10 years of professional experience at a finance company as a software engineer in Bangladesh. Along with designing and developing software features and reports, I also worked in the IT helpdesk to provide tier 2 and tier 3 support to clients. In Canada, I completed a UX design course from University of Toronto, School of Continuing Studies in 2025. Now I am working a freelancing job at TELUS Digital AI Data Solution as an Online Data Analyst. I am looking to progress my career in the Canadian health sector by leveraging my skills in software development, data management, user support, and UX design.

Career Goals

At the end of the first semester, I would like to gain basic knowledge of Health Informatics, including Business Analysis, Project Management, and the Canadian healthcare system. I would update my resume, cover letter and refine my portfolio targeting Healthcare Data Analyst roles. My next short-term objective is to secure a co-op placement in a healthcare setting where I would be able to apply the learned skills to real clinical or operational data. I also aim to earn ECBA certification to augment my job prospects.

By the end of the second semester, I would like to have deeper knowledge and hands-on experience in areas such as EMR, clinical data, and healthcare data privacy. This will expand my knowledge and allow me to apply for health care positions as well, such as EMR Analyst, Clinical Data Analyst, Healthcare Data Analyst, or Privacy Analyst.

My long-term goal is to secure a full-time position in Health Informatics after successfully completing my co-op. Within the next two to three years, I want to establish myself as a Health Informatics professional and work for a well-established organization, particularly in hospitals, CIHI, or a healthcare technology organization that works with health data.

Strengths

One of my greatest strengths is my technical background. While working with an IT team at my previous company, I was directly involved in multiple IT projects, which helped me strengthen my skills such as requirement analysis, understanding pain points of the users, design and developing solutions and following up with user training and support. I can bring these skills into health data analysis by using different software tools.

Another strength I would say is my problem-solving ability. I often had to identify software-related problems, understand the root causes of financial data inconsistencies, and resolve them quickly to keep day-to-day transactions running smoothly. I am confident that I can apply these skills to health data analysis.

Attention to detail is another strength of mine. My previous and current jobs strongly require analyzing, synthesizing, and summarizing data accurately and handling valuable data carefully. This requires strong attention to detail. I think this transferable skill is important in Health Informatics because healthcare data requires meticulous attention to detail to maintain data accuracy and privacy.

Other strengths I would like to mention are teamwork, coordination, time management, and adaptability. In my previous work, I frequently had to communicate and collaborate effectively

with my IT team and other departments while meeting deadlines and providing user support. I believe these transferable skills are highly useful for my postgraduate group work and will also help me work effectively with different teams and stakeholders in the healthcare field.

Areas for Development

A few areas I need to improve are professional communication with stakeholders, presentation skills, confidence in group interviews, healthcare knowledge, and creating a portfolio based on my knowledge and current job market trends. Since my previous experience is mainly in IT and technical areas, I have limited exposure to professional communication with diverse stakeholders, project management, and presenting ideas toward a common goal, such as in a Business Analyst role.

Strategy for professional growth and development

I will improve my communication by taking a few steps. For example, I will actively participate in class and group discussions, practice articulating my thoughts clearly, and listen to the teacher, students, and other people's opinions. I believe that course group projects are the best opportunities to enhance communication and also build strong networking.

In addition, I would like to focus on strengthening my presentation skills. Group projects are areas where I can strengthen my presentation skills. Before each presentation, I also intend to practice explaining my ideas and organizing my main points clearly. By the end of the first semester, I expect to feel more confident and comfortable when presenting to a group.

Besides those skills, I need to improve my confidence in group interviews. I often feel nervous when speaking in front of several people, so I plan to improve my confidence through mock interviews in the Career Development & Planning class and regular practice.

Another step I will take is to refine my portfolio by including relevant Health Informatics projects based on my course learning and current trends to meet co-op or job requirements.

Conclusion

In conclusion, my goal is to build a career in Health Informatics by combining my previous IT experience, UX Design knowledge, and new healthcare knowledge. My technical, problem-solving, and user-centered design skills will help me to better understand the user needs in the health care sector. I will continue to improve my communication, presentation, interview skills through regular practice and course projects. By following professional strategies, I hope to become well prepared for a co-op position and future employment in the Health Informatics sector.